COST Intelligence Report

Report as_of: **2026-10-25** | Market data as_of: **2026-10-23** | Market fetched: **2026-10-26 01:17 UTC**

Costco Wholesale Corporation | Consumer Defensive / Discount Stores

AI status: **Available** | Configured model: **openai/gpt-oss-20b** | News snapshot: **2026-10-25**

Classification review flags: **2** (automated anomaly checks, not established errors; see flagged articles below).

Report rendering uses saved source snapshots with separate observation dates. The daily price bar may be provisional before the listing market closes. Check source dates and availability.

Publication-age audit (relative to report date): 18 in the current event window; 2 presented as historical context; 0 missing publication dates. Recent publication does not verify the underlying claim.

News (report-date window: previous 7 days plus report date): **22** unique headlines; **22** classified or explicitly excluded; **0** still unclassified. Named publishers: **10**. Latest RSS publication: **2026-10-25**.

Quantitative

Metric	Value
Close	1003.3200
Return 1D (%)	-1.4624
Return 1W (%)	1.4366
Return 1M (%)	10.9009
Return YTD (%)	16.8620
Return 1Y (%)	7.1253
Annualized volatility (%)	19.7998
Beta vs SPY	-0.1841
Max drawdown (%)	-18.1993
Sharpe (rf=0)	0.4477
Downside deviation (rf=0, %)	13.7252
Sortino (rf=0)	0.6459
Historical VaR 95% (1D, %)	2.0766
Historical ES 95% (1D, %)	2.7374
Correlation vs SPY	-0.1185
Tracking error vs SPY (%)	24.7857
P/E (trailing)	48.33
P/B	12.42
EV/EBITDA	30.56
Revenue growth (%)	11.10
Forward P/E (estimate)	40.09
Gross margin (%)	12.77
Operating margin (%)	3.79
Return on equity (%)	28.40

Metric	Value
Free cash flow yield (%)	1.52
MA50	938.8648
Close vs MA50 (%)	6.8652
MA200	967.6397
Close vs MA200 (%)	3.6874
RSI (14, Wilder)	69.1972
MACD (12,26)	22.1491
MACD signal (9)	16.0507
MACD histogram	6.0984

Methodology: adjusted daily closes (yfinance auto_adjust=True; Stooq fallback if unavailable). 1Y return uses the last trading day on or before the one-year boundary. Risk metrics use historical returns and are not forecasts; asset and SPY returns are not FX-adjusted in cross-listing comparisons. Free cash flow yield is unavailable unless vendor financial and listing currencies match. See unavailable values as N/A.

HOW TO READ THE QUANTITATIVE SECTION

These rule-based bands are judgment choices for this research report, not investment advice.

The table above contains the complete metric set. This compact guide highlights ten research-context measures; definitions and full interpretation are retained in the accompanying Markdown and data snapshots.

- **Return 1D (%)**: The adjusted closing price change over one trading day is measured as a percentage. Observed: -1.4624. Adjusted price fell over this period.
- **Return 1Y (%)**: The adjusted closing price change over one year is measured as a percentage. Observed: 7.1253. Adjusted price rose over this period.
- **Annualized volatility (%)**: The variability of daily returns is scaled to one year as a percentage. Observed: 19.7998. Low annualized volatility.
- **Historical VaR 95% (1D, %)**: Observed daily loss at the empirical fifth-percentile return, floored at zero; not a maximum loss. Observed: 2.0766.
- **Historical ES 95% (1D, %)**: Average observed loss in returns at or below the empirical fifth percentile, floored at zero. Observed: 2.7374.
- **Beta vs SPY**: Beta estimates how sensitively returns move with the SPY market benchmark. Observed: -0.1841. Inverse market sensitivity.
- **Max drawdown (%)**: The largest peak-to-trough price decline in the sampled history is measured as a percentage. Observed: -18.1993. Moderate peak-to-trough loss magnitude.
- **Sharpe (rf=0)**: Sharpe measures annualized return per unit of volatility using a zero risk-free rate. Observed: 0.4477. Modest risk-adjusted return.
- **P/E (trailing)**: The share price is divided by trailing earnings per share. Observed: 48.3295. High trailing earnings multiple under the research bands.
- **RSI (14, Wilder)**: The 14-period relative strength index compares recent gains with losses on a 0 to 100 scale. Observed: 69.1972. Neutral momentum reading.

Tailwinds

1. Prediction: $5,000 in Costco Stock Will Trail the Market Through 2030

Long■term forecast that Costco stock will outperform the market through 2030.

Date: **2026-10-23** | Impact: **high** | Horizon: **long** | Confidence: **0.7**

Publication age: 2 days before report date.

Sources: The Motley Fool [1], The Motley Fool [2]

Headwinds

1. Costco (COST) Stock Price Forecast: June Sales Up 10.6% But Stock Fell After Hours - Short to $899?

June sales forecast up, yet stock fell after hours, indicating potential downside pressure.

Date: **2026-10-24** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 1 days before report date.

Sources: TradingKey

2. Are You Overpaying For Costco Stock Versus Its Rivals?

Questioning whether Costco shares are overpriced relative to competitors, implying valuation concerns.

Date: **2026-10-21** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.7**

Publication age: 4 days before report date.

Sources: Trefis

3. Costco Wholesale Has Fallen More Than 10% From Its Peak Before. Here's What History Says Happens Next.

Costco’s share price dropped 10% from peak, indicating potential downside risk.

Date: **2026-10-18** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 7 days before report date (historical context; not a new market-moving event).

Sources: The Motley Fool

Catalysts

1. Costco's Last Stock Split Was in 2000. Is Its Board Close to Another?

Date: **2026-10-22** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 3 days before report date.

Sources: Yahoo Finance [1], Yahoo Finance [2]

2. Costco Turned $1,000 Into $8,018 in Ten Years While the S&P 500 Delivered $3,564

Date: **2026-10-22** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 3 days before report date.

Sources: 24/7 Wall St.

3. Costco Wholesale Corporation $COST Stock: WASHINGTON TRUST Co Increases Position

Date: **2026-10-25** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 0 days before report date.

Sources: MarketBeat

4. Costco Is Paying a Dividend Next Month. Here’s the Deadline to Buy the Stock

Date: **2026-10-21** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 4 days before report date.

Sources: South Florida Reporter

5. What Could Surprise Costco Stock Investors On The Upside?

Speculation on potential positive surprises for Costco investors.

Date: **2026-10-22** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.6**

Review suggested: low_uncalibrated_model_confidence (not a confirmed classification error).

Publication age: 3 days before report date.

Sources: Trefis

6. Costco (COST) Stock Looks Expensive Despite Strong Sales Growth

Analysts note high valuation amid sales growth, suggesting caution for investors.

Date: **2026-10-19** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.9**

Publication age: 6 days before report date.

Sources: Yahoo Finance

7. Is Trending Stock Costco Wholesale Corporation (COST) a Buy Now?

Opinion piece questioning if Costco is a good buy at current price.

Date: **2026-10-20** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.9**

Publication age: 5 days before report date.

Sources: Yahoo Finance

8. Is Costco (COST) a Buy as Wall Street Analysts Look Optimistic?

Analysts express optimism, recommending a buy for Costco shares.

Date: **2026-10-23** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.9**

Publication age: 2 days before report date.

Sources: Yahoo Finance

9. Costco (COST) Advances While Market Declines: Some Information for Investors

Costco shares rise despite broader market downturn, indicating resilience.

Date: **2026-10-22** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.9**

Publication age: 3 days before report date (historical context; not a new market-moving event).

Sources: Yahoo Finance

10. Costco Wholesale Corporation $COST Stock: Sterling Capital Management LLC Decreases Stake

Sterling Capital reduces its stake in Costco, potentially signaling a shift in investor confidence.

Date: **2026-10-25** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.9**

Publication age: 0 days before report date.

Sources: MarketBeat

11. The Zacks Analyst Blog Highlights Costco, Walt Disney, Marriott, Park Aerospace and Flanigan's

Zacks blog spotlights Costco among other stocks, indicating moderate interest.

Date: **2026-10-19** | Impact: **low** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.6**

Review suggested: low_uncalibrated_model_confidence (not a confirmed classification error).

Publication age: 6 days before report date.

Sources: Yahoo Finance

12. Truist reiterates Hold on Costco stock citing strong comps

Truist maintains a Hold rating on Costco, citing strong comparable company performance.

Date: **2026-10-19** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.9**

Publication age: 6 days before report date.

Sources: Investing.com

13. CICC Initiates a Buy Rating on Costco (COST)

CICC upgrades Costco to a Buy rating, signaling positive outlook.

Date: **2026-10-24** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.9**

Publication age: 1 days before report date.

Sources: The Globe and Mail

14. Costco Wholesale (NASDAQ:COST) Stock Falls 1.5% - Should You Sell?

Costco shares dropped 1.5%, prompting sell■side questions.

Date: **2026-10-23** | Impact: **low** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 2 days before report date.

Sources: MarketBeat

15. Costco Stock Forecast: Q4 Sales Strength Meets a Membership Growth Test

Analysts predict strong Q4 sales but warn membership growth may lag, affecting future revenue.

Date: **2026-10-24** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **medium** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 1 days before report date.

Sources: TradingKey

Risks

1. Costco Wholesale Corporation $COST Stock Holdings Cut by Wedbush Securities Inc.

Wedbush reduced its Costco holdings, signaling potential concerns about the company's valuation.

Date: **2026-10-25** | Impact: **medium** | Horizon: **short** | Confidence: **0.8**

Publication age: 0 days before report date.

Sources: MarketBeat

Peer Comparables

Ticker	P/E	P/B	EV/EBITDA	Rev growth (%)	Mkt cap (local)	1Y ret (%)
COST	**48.33**	**12.42**	**30.56**	**11.10**	**444.60B USD**	**7.13**
WMT	43.44	9.69	23.17	5.90	954.09B USD	13.14
TGT	15.86	3.89	9.68	5.30	69.40B USD	68.64
BJ	22.24	6.09	13.88	15.70	13.37B USD	13.23

Peers fetched as_of: 2026-10-25; COST reuses existing data. Fundamentals are yfinance info snapshots; missing values are not interpolated.

Earnings Calendar

Last reported earnings: **2026-09-24**
Next expected earnings: **2026-12-10** (yfinance; expected dates may change)

Macro (FRED)

Metric	Series	Latest value	Obs. date
Unemployment rate (%)	UNRATE	4.200	2026-09-01
Consumer Price Index (1982–1984=100)	CPIAUCSL	336.298	2026-09-01
Federal funds rate (%)	FEDFUNDS	3.750	2026-09-01
ISM Manufacturing PMI	NAPM	N/A	N/A

Fetched as_of: 2026-10-25

Latest Filing (EDGAR)

Form: **10-K** | Filing date: **2026-10-07**
Revenue (latest quarter): 69,597,000,000.00 USD; period 2025-11-24/2026-02-15; fiscal 2026/Q2
Net income (latest quarter): 2,192,000,000.00 USD; period 2026-02-16/2026-05-10; fiscal 2026/Q3
SEC filing: Open on SEC EDGAR

SEC requests use the configured organization and contact identity. Financial values use directly reported periods of approximately three months, without deriving quarters from cumulative values.

Sources

- [1] The Motley Fool (news.google.com)
- [2] The Motley Fool (news.google.com)
- [3] TradingKey (news.google.com)
- [4] Trefis (news.google.com)
- [5] The Motley Fool (news.google.com)
- [6] Yahoo Finance (news.google.com)
- [7] Yahoo Finance (news.google.com)
- [8] 24/7 Wall St. (news.google.com)
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- [19] The Globe and Mail (news.google.com)
- [20] MarketBeat (news.google.com)
- [21] TradingKey (news.google.com)
- [22] MarketBeat (news.google.com)

API documentation: SEC EDGAR APIs | FRED observations

Research notes and limitations

Daily multi-source research; AI items require human spot checks; RSS coverage is not guaranteed. Missing market data or fundamentals are marked N/A; no numbers are fabricated.

This report is not investment advice.